



Cashing In on a Data Center By Selling Cold Beer to Builders

DESIREE RIOS FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Once a Quiet Farmhouse, Now a One-Stop Shop for an Army of Laborers

By JULIET MACUR

ABILENE, Texas — It was quitting time at the giant construction site, sending the afternoon rush down a crumbling two-lane country road toward a new convenience store called the Elmdale Outpost.

Dust-covered pickup trucks from near and far — Louisiana, North Carolina, Mexico — pulled into its parking lot, and weary workers walked through the door, their boots leaving a trail of dirt inside.

The tiny Swiss Army knife of a shop carries anything the workers might need. Toothpaste and toilet paper, sweet potatoes and spicy-hot snacks, and beer. At every turn, ice-cold beer. An entire separate room of floor-to-ceiling beer. More than 60 brands, including a dozen

A couple in Abilene, Texas, opened the Elmdale Outpost when a \$25 billion complex came to town. “Everything around here’s changed overnight,” an owner said.

varieties of michelada alone.

The store’s primary appeal, though, is its proximity to the construction site, six miles away. Or, more precisely, its proximity to the sprawling, new 148-acre R.V. park next door, built to serve thousands of temporary laborers.

An armada of those workers — pipe fitters, HVAC technicians, ironworkers and more — has come to this rural area at the northeast edge of Abilene, Texas, to build the \$25 billion

Frontier data center complex, part of the half-trillion dollar Stargate project that President Trump promoted last year as “the largest A.I. infrastructure project in history.” The flagship Stargate data center campus is also under construction, on the other side of town.

“Y’all opened up a good spot right here,” a foundation contractor from Colorado told the store owner, Sam Holt Jr., while buying a six-pack of Dos Equis.

After a 10-hour day in the Texas sun, he said he couldn’t resist the red sign painted on the store’s corrugated tin roof: “BEER.”

“Yep, we’re just trying to serve our new neighbors,” Holt replied.

Late last year, “neighbors” meant a handful

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DANIEL BEREHULAK/THE NEW YORK TIMES

A private table at Pioneer Plus, Myanmar’s most exclusive nightclub, costs hundreds of dollars.

MYANMAR DISPATCH

War Rages, but the Party Never Ends for the Rich

By HANNAH BEECH

YANGON, Myanmar — After midnight, amid a war, the D.J. hyped the crowd.

“Are you ready to party?” he yelled into the mic, adding an expletive for emphasis.

The partygoers of Pioneer Plus, the most exclusive nightclub in the war-torn nation of Myanmar, were ready. The D.J. had come all the way from Croatia, after all. Young women gyrated onstage. Johnnie Walker flowed, but only Blue Label be-

Caviar and Lavish Trips as Others Suffer

cause that is the way these high-rollers roll. A private table for the evening — with hookah, imported fruit and pyramids of frosted shot glasses — costs hundreds of dollars to book.

In the bathrooms, and on the dance floor in stolen moments between flashes of the strobe, some denizens of Pioneer Plus

swallowed pastel tablets that tinged their breath with vanilla or grape candy. The kick from these methamphetamine and caffeine concoctions, branded with the names of local drug syndicates, lasts for hours.

Myanmar, which five years ago descended into full-scale civil war after a military junta overthrew the elected government, led by Daw Aung San Suu Kyi, is in desperate need of a diversion, a respite, a prolonged high.

No one in Myanmar is unaf-

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Shooter’s Father Given 15 Years For Negligence

By RICK ROJAS
and JOHNNY KAUFFMAN

ATLANTA — The father of a teenager who fatally shot four people at his Georgia high school was sentenced on Thursday to 15 years in prison after a jury found he bore criminal responsibility for his son’s deadly attack in 2024.

The father, Colin Gray, had been convicted in March of murder and involuntary manslaughter, among other charges. Prosecutors argued that he shouldered significant blame for the shooting in Winder, Ga., because he had given his son, Colt, then 14, the rifle that was used and failed to heed signs of his son’s deteriorating mental health and growing obsession with violence.

Prosecuting the parents of juveniles who carry out mass shootings has become one of the latest fronts in the search for accountability in a country frustrated by recurring gun violence. The case against Mr. Gray has stood out for the severity of the charges. His potential sentence ranged from 10 years of probation to 243 years in prison; prosecutors had asked for an 80-year sentence — effectively a life sentence for Mr. Gray, 55.

Judge Nicholas Primm of State Superior Court in Barrow County noted the novelty of the case, describing it as the first of its kind in Georgia and the second in the country. He acknowledged that Mr. Gray had not orchestrated the attack, or even been aware of his son’s specific plans. But his failure to act let the attack happen.

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Hospitals Say More Patients Are Uninsured

Coverage Is Lost After Cuts to Obamacare

By REED ABELSON

More and more uninsured patients are showing up in hospital emergency rooms and clinics, having lost their coverage under the Affordable Care Act.

Executives running some of the biggest hospital systems, including large for-profit chains spanning many states, expressed concern over the unexpectedly sharp rise in uninsured patients and the costs associated with treating them.

And many executives said that the hospitals were also reporting more unpaid medical bills and providing more in the way of charity care. Some hospital systems also found that patients were forgoing or postponing lucrative elective surgeries like knee replacements in recent months.

The significant increase in uninsured patients, about 20 percent in some cases, was disclosed in earnings reports in the past week and interviews with nonprofit hospital groups. Major hospital officials expressed growing unease over lost revenues amounting to hundreds of millions of dollars across the country’s vast health systems.

Some executives attributed the diminishing numbers to the decision by congressional Republicans to end the more generous subsidies, or tax credits, that were initially put in place during the Covid pandemic and helped many people pay their monthly insurance premiums. While the vast majority of people enrolled in an A.C.A. plan this year still receive a federal subsidy, the federal assistance is less generous. People are paying significantly more for a plan in 2026, on average, and anyone making more than four times the federal poverty level — \$62,600 for an individual — no longer qualified for help.

Since the beginning of the year, enrollment in Obamacare has dropped by about three million, or 13 percent, according to the latest government figures. Insurance companies expect even more people to drop their A.C.A. plans.

The Trump administration has described the falloff largely as a result of its crackdown on fraud.

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TRUMP CONSIDERS PULLING BLANCHE AS PICK FOR NOW

TWO HOLDOUTS IN G.O.P.

Stalemate Over Tax Deal Snags Senate Vote on Attorney General

This article is by Glenn Thrush, Michael Gold and Carl Hulse.

WASHINGTON — Todd Blanche’s nomination to become attorney general suffered a serious blow on Thursday when President Trump threatened to withdraw Mr. Blanche’s name rather than place limits on a tax immunity deal that would benefit himself and his family, as demanded by two Republican senators.

Mr. Trump’s threat, posted on social media, followed 24 hours of frenetic and fruitless negotiations among Mr. Blanche, the White House and the two senators, John Cornyn of Texas and Thom Tillis of North Carolina, who are not returning to Congress next year.

“I have no objection to temporarily withdrawing Todd’s name, if they do not do the right thing, and putting him back after Cornyn and Tillis are out of office,” Mr. Trump wrote, in a fight that has exposed the limits of his power over Congress.

That set off a late-day scramble to rescue Mr. Blanche’s nomination, and the semblance of intra-party, interbranch comity. Mr. Tillis and Mr. Cornyn met privately with Mr. Blanche Thursday afternoon in the offices of the National Republican Senatorial Committee near the Capitol. It was not immediately clear if they broke the impasse.

Mr. Cornyn and Mr. Tillis object to a deal negotiated by Mr. Blanche and Mr. Trump’s personal lawyers to resolve a lawsuit the president had filed against the I.R.S. The deal gave Mr. Trump, his family and his businesses broad immunity against I.R.S. audits, potentially saving them at least \$100 million in penalties. Democrats and even some Republican lawmakers criticized the deal as a giveaway to the Trump family.

The two senators want to narrow the deal in order to advance Mr. Blanche’s nomination, de-

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HEIDI ZEIGER/SHEDD AQUARIUM, VIA REUTERS

Sheri Hendricks with a whale at Shedd Aquarium in Chicago.

Your Travel Plans Complex? Try Flying 30 Beluga Whales.

By REMY TUMIN

There is nothing normal about moving a beluga whale.

First, you have to find a cargo plane that can accommodate the whale and at least one, if not more, attendants per whale.

Then, there are the foam- and rubber-lined container boxes, specific to the whale’s size and weight, and large enough to hold the whale and the stretcher that it will rest on.

There’s also the matter of the crane that will hoist the whale from its enclosure into the box, onto a waiting truck that will cart it off to the airport.

Now, repeat that for 30 whales. Aquariums across the United States and Spain are working to relocate these 30 whales from a shuttered aquarium in Canada.

Six made their way out of Cana-

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INTERNATIONAL A4-10

Russian Attacks Kill at Least 8

Several cities in Ukraine were hit, including Lviv, above. One missile crashed in Poland, a NATO member. PAGE A6

Iran Blamed in Minnesota Hack

The attribution of a cyberattack on dozens of water systems to Tehran was preliminary, investigators said. PAGE A8

NATIONAL A11-17, 20

Trump Project Races Ahead

Construction of the White House ballroom and bunker complex has progressed since December, when a federal lawsuit first sought to halt it. PAGE A14

‘Frozen Zone’ Scrapes By

Small businesses near the former Pfizer building in Manhattan were shut when the tower began to buckle. PAGE A16

OBITUARIES B11

Singer and Oscar Winner

Glen Hansard, frontman of the Irish band the Frames, shared the award for “Falling Slowly” from “Once.” He was 56.



WEEKEND ARTS C1-8

Tuned In to Tanglewood

The Boston Symphony Orchestra’s summer home is an idyllic setting. But changes have caused turmoil. PAGE C1

High Fashion, Hands-On

The Dutch designer Iris van Herpen is inviting museumgoers in Brooklyn to pleat a piece of fabric with her. PAGE C1

BUSINESS B1-6

Climate Change and Cattle

In China, as increased rain makes grasslands possible in areas that once were deserts, the world’s largest beef importer is becoming more self-reliant by expanding domestic herds. PAGE B1

American Economy Slows

The U.S. G.D.P. expanded at an annual rate of 1.5 percent in the second quarter, down from 2.1 percent in the first quarter, as persistent price pressures are unsettling financial markets. PAGE B1

OPINION A18-19

Sharon Waxman

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SPORTS B7-10, 12

Why Moore Opted for Oregon

Dante Moore could have been drafted second overall in last year’s N.F.L. draft. But the quarterback chose to stay for one last run at college glory. PAGE B7

